01. Personas

Status	Draft v1.0 for team review. Aligned to `architecture.md` (Core owns commerce; vendor-admin is the seller back-office)
Date	2026-10-20
Owner	To be assigned (product)
Inputs	Team meeting transcript, the marketing website (`shazlosite`), the current app and backend, `architecture.md`

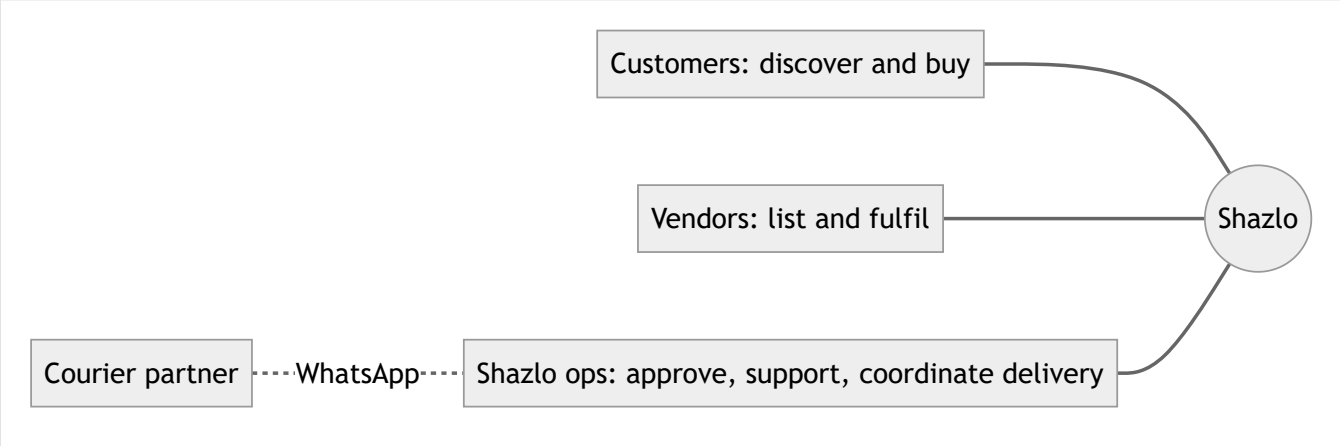
Legend used in all docs: `[As-is]` verified in today's code or site, `[Target]` proposed design, `[MVP]` what is built by Oct 30, `[Assumption]` a hypothesis that needs validation.

> Every persona below is a **hypothesis**, built from the meeting transcript and the website, not from interviews. Section 7 lists the research that turns them into facts.

1. Who Shazlo serves

Shazlo is a swipe-based fashion discovery app. It launches in **Ahmedabad**, then the rest of **Gujarat** `[As-is: meeting]`. The target customers are **Gen Z and millennials**, and the target vendors are **small and local fashion businesses** `[As-is: meeting]`. Vendors do not pay a listing fee; Shazlo earns a **commission**, decided as **15% flat** for the pilot vendors (the meeting discussed 10 to 20%). Delivery is handled by a **third party** for the first three to four months, coordinated by ops over WhatsApp. At launch customers pay **cash or UPI on delivery**; online payment is built but stays switched off until the payment provider approves Shazlo's account.

The product has three sides, served by two backend services (Core for customers and commerce, the vendor-admin service for the seller side):



Side	Uses	Backed by
Customers	The customer app (React Native)	**Core service**: accounts, feed, closets, cart, checkout, orders, stock and payments (the whole buying path)
Vendors	The vendor portal (web, phone friendly)	**Vendor-admin service**: vendor accounts, product authoring, order view and fulfilment actions (which it sends to Core), statements
Shazlo ops	The admin screens	**Vendor-admin service**: approvals, order operations (sent to Core), audit log

Each side has its **own login**. A vendor owner who also shops in the app has two accounts, one in each service; this is deliberate (a customer account can never reach vendor or admin data) and is called out where it matters below.

2. Priority at a glance

ID	Persona	Side	Priority for MVP (Oct 30)
P1	Aanya, the student shopper	Customer	**Primary**
P2	Riya, the young professional	Customer	Secondary
P3	Kiran, the boutique owner	Vendor	**Primary**
P4	Meera, the catalog assistant	Vendor	Secondary
P5	Ops admin (Shazlo team member)	Internal	**Primary**
P6	Courier partner	External	Supported through WhatsApp only
P7	Investor or press visitor	Website	Website only, no product work
P8	Stylist or creator	Customer / vendor hybrid	Later (the website lists a Creator Programme)

3. Customer personas

P1. Aanya, the student shopper `[Assumption]`

Who	18 to 24, college student in Ahmedabad, lives with family or in a hostel
Context	Mid-range Android phone, Instagram and WhatsApp all day, pays with UPI or cash on delivery
Budget	Roughly ₹500 to ₹2,500 per item
Goals	Find trendy, affordable pieces she would not find by scrolling; save looks to plan outfits; share picks with friends
Frustrations	Endless scrolling and filters, not knowing which small brand to trust, sizing risk, delivery that never arrives, being forced to sign up before browsing
Jobs to be done	"When I am bored or planning a night out, show me clothes that match my taste in a few swipes so I can save or buy."
Success looks like	30 or more swipes in her first session; saves items to a closet; places a first order within 14 days
MVP must-haves	Start as a guest with no sign-up; fast feed with sharp photos; closets she can share by link; an order request she can pay for with cash or UPI on delivery; order status in the app and delivery updates
Risks	Slow images on weak networks; distrust of unknown vendors; privacy concerns about collected taste data; a "could not place your order, try again" message if Core is briefly down (checkout does not depend on the vendor back-office, so it keeps working even when that is down)

P2. Riya, the young professional `[Assumption]`

Who	25 to 34, works in a city office, shops for work and occasion wear
Context	Android or iPhone, pays by UPI or card, short on time
Goals	Curated options that fit quickly; quality she can rely on; easy returns
Frustrations	Poor size and fabric information, returns that are a hassle, too many near-identical choices
Jobs to be done	"Help me assemble a few good outfits without hours of browsing."

Success looks like	Orders more than once in 60 days; uses closets to plan; filters by price, fabric and product type
MVP must-haves	Filters for price, fabric and product type; the vendor's return policy visible on the product; product photos from several angles
Risks	Expects online payment and fast delivery; online payment is built but off at launch until the provider approves the account, so the app offers cash or UPI on delivery only

4. Vendor personas

P3. Kiran, the boutique owner `[Assumption]`

Who	26 to 40, runs a small boutique or direct-to-consumer label from Ahmedabad; 10 to 200 products
Context	Sells mainly through Instagram and WhatsApp, no developer, limited time for software, does everything from a phone. Signs in to the **vendor portal** with a vendor account (not a customer account)
Goals	Reach new customers without paying upfront; get orders that are simple to fulfil; get paid on time
Frustrations	High customer acquisition cost, listing fees, complicated seller dashboards, not trusting a platform to settle money fairly
What he accepts	A commission on each sale (**15% flat** for pilot vendors, to be confirmed with each vendor in the agreement); delivery by a Shazlo-arranged partner
Jobs to be done	"Let me list my products in minutes and get orders on WhatsApp, and only pay when something sells."
Success looks like	Registered and approved within two days; first product live in under 10 minutes; first order in two weeks
MVP must-haves	Simple application form; approval status he can see; a phone-friendly portal with its own login and an emailed invite after approval; product upload with price, stock, fabric, return policy and several photos; email order notifications with WhatsApp follow-up by ops; 4 business hours to confirm each order; a commission statement
Risks	Stock that is out of date; a missed order notification; unclear return rules (7-day window by default); delivery handoff mistakes; a product edit that sends an approved product back to review (title, description or photos) and takes it off the feed until approved again

Prospect stage: before he is a user, Kiran is a **website visitor** looking for terms (commission, no listing fee, how it works). His application goes to the vendor-admin service. See flow V1 in `02-user-flows.md`.

P4. Meera, the catalog assistant `[Assumption]`

Who	Works for a vendor, keeps the product list and stock up to date
Context	Laptop or phone, spreadsheets, product photos from a photographer or the owner's phone
Goals	Upload many products at once and update stock daily without repeating work
Frustrations	Entering one product at a time, rejected uploads with unclear reasons, image size limits
Success looks like	A spreadsheet of 50 products imports with errors listed per row, and she fixes only the bad rows
Access	A `vendor_staff` account created by the owner; she cannot change the return policy, the team or statements
MVP must-haves	Quick stock and price edits; image upload that works on a phone; CSV import with per-row errors (a stretch goal that is cut first if the schedule slips)

5. Internal and external personas

P5. Ops admin (a Shazlo team member) `[Assumption]`

Who	A founder or early team member doing operations by hand
Context	The admin screens (SQLAdmin in the vendor-admin service, behind Cloudflare Access, with a separate admin account), WhatsApp groups with vendors and the courier partner
Goals	Approve good vendors and products quickly, make sure no order is missed, handle returns and refunds, keep support responses fast
Frustrations	Manual tracking across chats and sheets, unclear order status, no audit trail
Success looks like	Product reviews done within 24 hours; zero orders unconfirmed for more than a few hours; every status change recorded
MVP must-haves	Queues for vendor applications and product reviews; an order list with status, one-click status changes and a mark-payment-collected action; WhatsApp message templates (click-to-chat links); an audit log; a view of events that failed to reach the app, with a retry button

P6. Courier partner (external actor) `[Assumption]`

A third-party delivery service (not yet named). For the first three to four months ops coordinate with it over WhatsApp and record the result in the admin screens. Later it may become an API integration with tracking webhooks. It is an external actor, not a user of Shazlo software, in the MVP.

P7. Investor or press visitor `[As-is: website]`

Arrives on the website, wants the story, traction and the deck. The site's only action is a "Request Deck" email to `connect@shazlo.store`. No product work is needed beyond accurate site content.

P8. Stylist or creator (later) `[As-is: website]`

The website's partnership types include a Creator Programme ("earn on every outfit"). It is not in the MVP and has no data model yet. It is listed so the closet and share features are designed to allow it later.

6. Not for now (anti-personas)

- Customers outside Gujarat, and international luxury shoppers.
- Minors under 18 (age and consent handling is an open question).
- Resellers and bots scraping the catalog.
- Large national brands that want an enterprise integration (the current catalog of scraped Zara and M&S items is a demo for discovery, not a vendor relationship).

7. Validate before relying on these

Interview **5 to 8 customers** and **5 to 8 vendors** in Ahmedabad in the first two weeks after launch (or this week for vendors, since a signed agreement is pending).

Question for	What we want to learn	What would change the plan
Customers	Do they trust cash or UPI on delivery? Which categories do they browse most? How much do they want to pay?	When to switch online payment on; different launch categories
Customers	Do swipes feel useful, or do they want search and filters first?	Raise filter work above recommendation work
Vendors	Who uploads products: the owner or staff? Phone or laptop?	Mobile-first portal; priority of CSV import
Vendors	Is the 15% commission acceptable? What delivery and returns do they already offer?	Commission per vendor; return policy fields
Vendors	Do they want orders by WhatsApp, email or the portal? Is a separate vendor login a problem?	Notification channel priority; vendor sign-in design
Ops	Where do orders get lost today?	Order status and reminder design

Open items that affect personas are collected in `open-questions.md` (language: English, Hindi and Gujarati; age limit). Return window (7 days), commission (15%), payment methods at launch and the confirmation window (4 business hours) are decided there.

8. Source notes

- Meeting transcript: target customers, launch city, commission, delivery, vendor portal scope, and the priority order.
- Website (`D:\shazlosite\Shazlo`): the partnership types, the Partner tab, the Creator Programme, the `/partner` form (price range slider default ₹2,500 to ₹5,000), the "Request Deck" action.
- Current app: guest start (`/auth/shadow`), closets, swipe gestures, the commented-out cart and profile tabs.
- `architecture.md`: which service each persona uses, separate logins, how orders flow between the two services.